mountainsides at a high altitude was gruelling. We had more than a dozen such tasks to rehearse, so the days and nights used to pass by pretty quickly. Each individual plan had also to be recorded and slides made thereof to present at the Div HQ, as and when required.

For some reason that escapes me, as per the orders, slides for the overhead projector (OHP) had to be made on glass panes using indelible ink of various colours. Once prepared, the slide had to be covered with another glass pane to avoid any smudging and the two glass panes had to be stuck firmly together. Each slide in effect was like a glass sandwich. The responsibility for making these slides as well as their safe custody in storage and transit devolved on the Adjutant. A slight change in the plan, route or timing and that slide had to be junked and remade. This took up a disproportionate amount of time and was not really worth the effort. It was a classic example of 'style' taking precedence over 'substance'. Thankfully, that practice didn't last long but it taught me a lesson to be practical. In fact, when I grew in rank and started visiting units, I made it a point to listen to the briefings outdoors at the Battalion or Company viewpoints, with at best one map enlargement for the sake of orientation. This method was much better for assessing whether an officer or JCO really knew his job without having to refer to slides.

Since Binaguri was a relatively new station, detailed plans had been made for its beautification, including an arboriculture plan detailing what kind of trees and decorative shrubs should be planted at various places. Each unit had the responsibility of planting these saplings and ensuring their survival. The GOC of the Division would go around each morning on horseback making note of which saplings had withered and conveying his displeasure to the unit concerned. Our *Khalsas* (and I use the

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